

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Bill would raise juvenile detention age

Advocates say measure reduces trauma in system disproportionately detrimental to Black children

By Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

In more than two decades as a juvenile probation officer in downstate Clinton County, Carla Stalnaker said barely a handful of children younger than 12 have

found themselves in her office. And only a small number of those were put in a detention center. But the juvenile justice veteran thinks it's time to phase out that option. "The old scared-straight thing... that doesn't work," Stalnaker said.

"They want help. They're not hard and bitter about the system yet." Illinois doesn't allow children under 10 to be held in detention facilities. But last year, there were about a dozen admissions of children under 12 and more than 60 of children who were 12 years old, according to data from the Illinois Juvenile Justice Commission. Cases like those are the subject of a bill that was passed in the state

Senate last week that, if approved by the House and signed by Gov. JB Pritzker, would essentially ban the detention of kids 12 and under, with some exceptions for 12-year-olds accused of certain violent crimes. The bill would do away with an option for youthful offenders that a report from the state's Juvenile Justice Commission described as "potentially life-altering" and

disproportionately detrimental to Black children. Advocates argue detention can add to trauma for children who in many cases have already experienced problems before they ever get into trouble with law enforcement, adding to risk factors that may lead them to act out again. Beyond that, younger children

Turn to Detention, Page 4



A spiritual pilgrimage

Worshippers and onlookers follow the annual Via Crucis procession down 18th Street in the Pilsen neighborhood of Chicago on Friday.

The annual Good Friday procession attracts hundreds to the South Side neighborhood. At top, Sofia Lemus, 13, carries a sign during the event, which has been held since the late 1970s.

E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS



Different kind of high life

4/20 events celebrate increased pot use as alcohol sales decline

By Robert McCoppin
Chicago Tribune

To celebrate the informal cannabis holiday of 4/20, diners at Eden restaurant will feast on marijuana-infused beet salad, poached flounder and a pork shoulder paired with mocktails — with no alcohol. The \$210 gourmet meal at the Avondale eatery will cater to a growing interest in weed and a declining taste for booze, chef Devon Quinn said. Diners likely will get high, but won't be stumbling out drunk, he said. "We have seen a significant trend towards less alcohol consumption," Quinn said. "People are becoming more



Devon Quinn, chief culinary officer with The Paramount Group, checks on a sous vide bag containing pear syrup infused with cannabis Thursday as he prepares a cannabis-themed dinner for Sunday at Eden restaurant in Chicago's Avondale neighborhood. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

mindful of the negative impacts of alcohol. But we still want to have cool dining experiences, and this is another way to do it." The dinner is on the upscale end of a wide variety of events being held to celebrate April 20. According to popular lore, the cannabis holiday was named after a group of friends who used to meet regularly at 4:20 p.m. to get high. Since recreational cannabis was legalized in Illinois starting

in 2020, sales of the drug have increased to \$2 billion a year. The holiday this year has morphed into a weekendlong cultural celebration, and a marketing event for businesses. Stores offer special discounts and giveaways, and see a surge in business, capitalizing on a growing commercial trend. The rate of people reporting past-year use of cannabis more than doubled from

Turn to Cannabis, Page 2

US airstrike kills scores at Yemen port held by rebels

By Jon Gambrell
Associated Press

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — A U.S. airstrike on an important oil port held by Yemen's Houthi rebels killed more than 70 people and wounded many others, the Iran-backed rebel group said Friday, marking a major escalation in the military campaign President Donald Trump launched against the faction last month. The overnight strike on the Ras Isa port sent massive fireballs billowing skyward and turned tanker trucks into burning wrecks. It was the first American attack on a Houthi-controlled oil

facility since the U.S. began its new bombing campaign. It also came just before the resumption of negotiations in Rome between the U.S. and Iran over Tehran's rapidly advancing nuclear program, which Washington has linked to its Yemen campaign. The U.S. is targeting the Houthis because of the group's attacks on shipping in the Red Sea, a crucial global trade route, and on Israel. The Houthis are the last militant group in Iran's self-described Axis of Resistance that is capable of regularly attacking Israel. The port serves as a major hub

Turn to Yemen, Page 6

TODAY'S WEATHER High **56** Low **45**
Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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